

RANCHI | Track 2 Revolution



MAHADEO SEN

A FORMER MAOIST ARRIVES TO FILE HIS NOMINATION FOR THE ASSEMBLY POLLS

Kameshwar Baitha, who won from Palamu parliamentary seat (Jharkhand) on a Jharkhand Mukti Morcha ticket in the general elections. Since many of these aspiring politicians are in jail, their wives seek votes on their behalf through intensive campaigns. Affidavits filed by the former rebels are also a good read. Keshwar Yadav, 47, who is

Some Maoists in Jharkhand seem to have gone beyond their yoked yearnings for a classless society. Instead, they are battling it out for a New Revolution—a slice of power in Jharkhand. At least a dozen “reformed” rebels are contesting the Assembly elections, aspiring to become what they supposedly disliked the most. They have drawn inspiration from

contesting on an RJD ticket, has claimed an insurance cover of Rs 55,000. His son has a policy worth Rs 5.5 lakh. Ganesh Ganju, contesting from Simaria, has declared an insurance policy of Rs 50,000. The JMM is fielding at least five former Maoists in the polls, all who have fixed deposits and accounts with various banks.

by Amitabh Srivastava

Power Play

After Delhi hosts the 2010 Commonwealth Games and the administrators satiate their hunger for power and attention, more mega events are to be bid for. Coming up: the 2019 Asian Games and the 2024 Olympics. In the capital, of course.

MUMBAI | Last Rights

Discrimination isn't only for the living because prejudices don't even spare the dead. Gautam Korde, a Buddhist alleges that even Dr Babasaheb Ambedkar, was discriminated even in death as a Hindu crematorium in Dadar refused to cremate him. Years after Ambedkar's final rites were performed in Chowpatty, Korde's advocate Sushan Kunjuraman has filed a PIL in the Bombay High Court demanding a separate crematorium for Buddhists. Korde claims that Hindu priests cannot perform the last rites of Buddhists. In the absence of the religion's clergy or even a sufficient number of monks in big cities, families themselves are compelled to



BUDDHISTS WANT A SEPARATE CREMATORIUM

perform the rites. Maharashtra accounts for the second largest Dalit population in India at 1.1 crore; of this, almost 7 per cent are Buddhists.

by Malini Bhupta

BANGALORE | Taking Off

The Government Flying School in Jakkur is taxiing for a formal takeoff early next month. A brand new Cessna 172R will join four other small trainers, including a Hansa-3, at the 211-acre school founded in 1948. Built on land donated by the Mysore maharajas who had their own Dakota aircraft, the school is run by



SANJAY RAMCHANDRAN

the state department of youth services and sports. It had hit an air pocket in 1997 until IAS officer I.M. Vittala Murthy took over. He had the school's licence renewed from the DGCA, obtained an airworthiness certificate for its small fleet and put in a flight simulator for the first 35 students. India's first woman pilot Usha Sundaram, who graduated from the school's first batch, flew Jawaharlal Nehru from Jakkur to Mysore in a Dakota. Says Murthy, “We have been on the tarmac too long, now it is time to take off.”

by Stephen David